

A blue-tinted background image showing a hand holding a smartwatch. The watch screen displays '101', 'FACTORY RHYTHM', 'TEAM', and '0:00:00'. A yellow star icon is positioned above the hand.

# The Player-Coach Playbook

M.V.P.  Accelerator™  
POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™



## Lesson 5

### *Play the Season — Sustainable Performance*



“Rest isn’t a bug;  
it’s a feature of  
high performance.  
It’s the strategic  
pause that fuels  
the next sprint.”



## Drill 5.1

# Pre-Game Huddle: *Your Focus for Lesson 5*

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.1)



### Instructions:

Welcome to Lesson 5. We are deep into the season, where cumulative fatigue can derail even the best plans. This lesson is about the science of sustainable high performance. The best Athleaders and coaches know that victory depends on managing **Well-being** and energy, not just time. Your role is to model these sustainable practices to ensure you and your team can finish the season strong and avoid burnout.

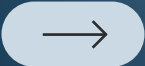
### ► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Conduct a personal “Energy Audit” to identify and manage your key energy drains and sources.
- » Learn to consciously model sustainable work practices to influence your team’s culture.
- » Develop a proactive plan for facilitating team recovery after intense periods of effort.

### The Science of Performance

In a study of high-performing leaders, 94% reported working more than 50 hours a week, and over half reported feeling burned out. This lesson provides the tactical plays to counter this trend.

# A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



## Drill 5.2

### LEAD SELF — The Personal Energy Audit

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.2)



**Instructions:**  
The most effective leaders are masters of energy management. Time is finite, but energy is renewable if managed correctly. This drill helps you gather data on your personal energy drains and fuel sources so you can optimize your performance.



**Action**  
For one full workday this week, use the log below to track your energy. At several points during the day, note the activity you were just doing and how it made you feel.

#### My Daily Energy Audit Log

| Time of Day    | Activity / Meeting / Task        | Energy Level After Activity<br>(Mark one) |                               |                                 |
|----------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| e.g., 10:00 AM | e.g., Team Budget Review Meeting | <input checked="" type="radio"/> Drained  | <input type="radio"/> Neutral | <input type="radio"/> Energized |
|                |                                  | <input type="radio"/> Drained             | <input type="radio"/> Neutral | <input type="radio"/> Energized |
|                |                                  | <input type="radio"/> Drained             | <input type="radio"/> Neutral | <input type="radio"/> Energized |
|                |                                  | <input type="radio"/> Drained             | <input type="radio"/> Neutral | <input type="radio"/> Energized |
|                |                                  | <input type="radio"/> Drained             | <input type="radio"/> Neutral | <input type="radio"/> Energized |

Analysis & Action Plan

1 My Biggest Energy Drainer Was

*(What single activity had the most negative impact on your energy?)*

 My Response

2 My Biggest Energy Giver Was

*(What single activity had the most positive impact on your energy?)*

 My Response

3 One Change I Will Make

*(Based on this audit, what is one specific change you can make to your schedule or workflow next week to minimize a drain or maximize a giver?)*

 My Response



Drill 5.3

LEAD OTHERS — Modeling Sustainable Practices

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.3)



Instructions:

Your habits create your team’s norms. The phrase “do as I say, not as I do” is the quickest way to lose credibility as a leader. Your play is to consciously model one behavior that sends a powerful signal to your team that **Well-being** is a non-negotiable part of high performance.



Action

Choose **one** of the following plays to run consistently this week. Check the box to commit to it.

☐ The Full Break

Take a full lunch break, completely away from your desk and email, and encourage your team to do the same.

☐ The “Schedule Send” Play

Use the “schedule send” feature for all emails written after 6 PM, ensuring they arrive during business hours the next day.

☐ The Gift of Time:

Proactively end a meeting you are leading 5-10 minutes early, explicitly giving everyone back time to transition.

☐ The Disconnect Praise

Explicitly praise a team member for taking their vacation time and fully disconnecting, reinforcing that rest is valued.



My Response



Reflection

Why is modeling one of these behaviors more powerful than simply telling your team to “take care of their well-being”?

Drill 5.4

LEAD OTHERS — The Team Recovery Protocol

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 5.4)



Instructions:

In sports, recovery isn't optional; it's a strategic part of the training cycle. The same is true for elite teams in business. Your play is to proactively plan for your team's recovery before they hit the wall after their next big push.



Action

Complete the Team Recovery Protocol Planner below, and then schedule the recovery event on the team calendar now. This makes it real.

Team Recovery Protocol Planner

1 Identify the Next Big Push

(What is the next major deadline, project launch, or intense period for your team?)



Project / Deadline



Target Date



2 Schedule a Recovery Protocol

*(What is one small but meaningful thing you can do as a team within a few days of that date to acknowledge the effort and facilitate recovery?)*

 Example

*A celebratory team lunch, a “no-meetings” afternoon, a retrospective focused only on lessons learned and celebrating wins, a half-day for professional development.*

 My Team’s Recovery Protocol



  
Recovery isn’t  
a pause from  
performance —  
it’s the rhythm that  
makes sustained  
performance possible.

# Locker Room Reflection

*(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 5.4)*

**Challenge:** What is one “unwritten rule” or implicit expectation on your team that might be contributing to a culture of burnout (e.g., everyone stays online late, instant Teams/Slack responses are expected, lunch is eaten at the desk)? What is one specific step you can take as the leader to begin to change it?

 My Response

 My notes